

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The existing IT procurement process involves several manual activities, which can cause delays when processing standard laptop requests. Since these laptops require configuration before delivery, any delay or missed task can increase user waiting time and place additional workload on the IT team.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want the standard laptop request process to be automated so that configuration tasks are created and assigned to the Hardware team after approval. This will help ensure that laptops are configured promptly and reduce unnecessary manual effort and user waiting time.

Project Objective:

The main objective of this project is to use ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the procurement and configuration workflow for standard laptops. The automation is intended to:

1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

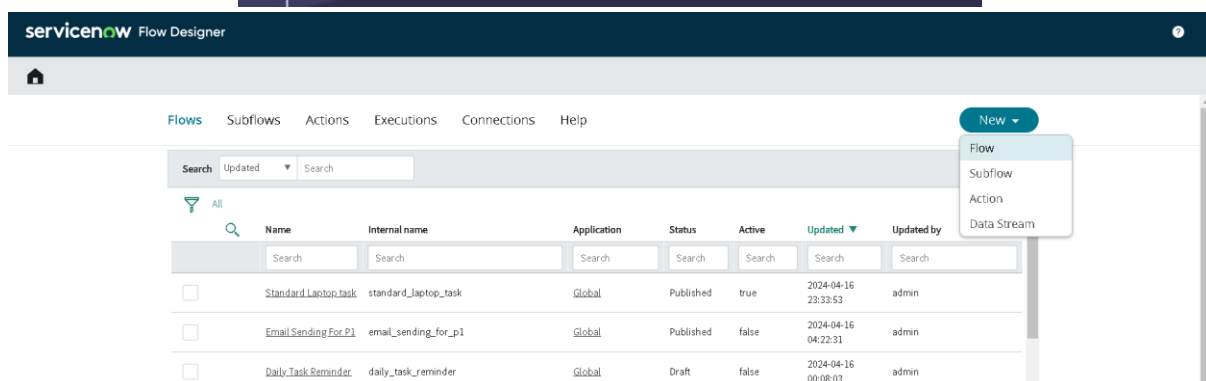
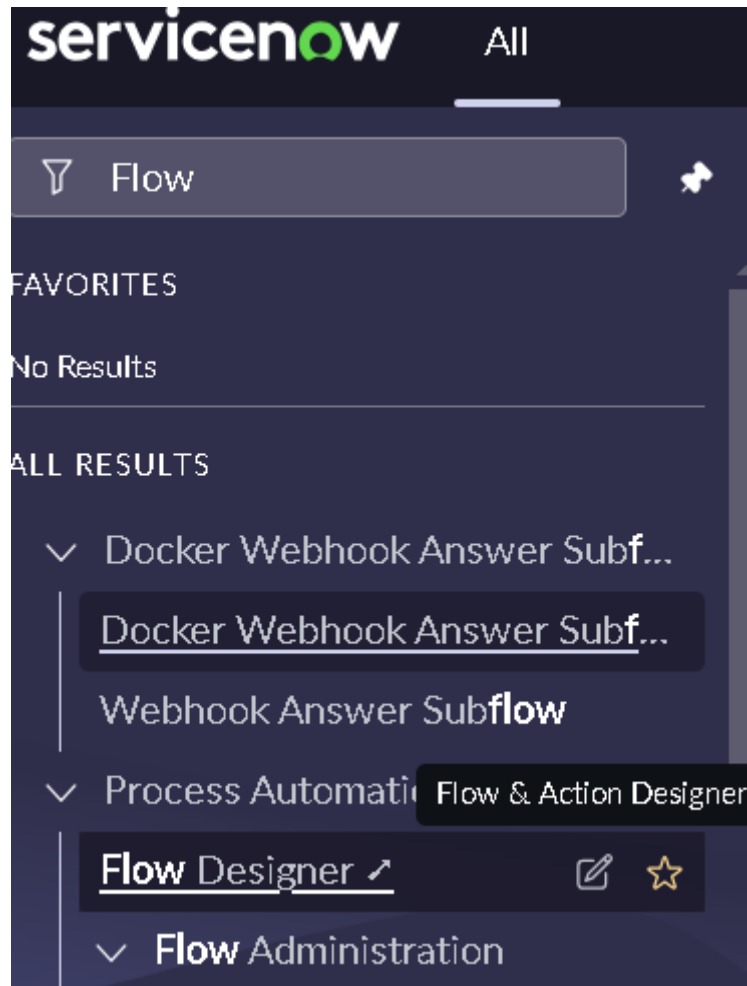
TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.

4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



Flow properties

* Flow name

Standard Laptop task

Description

Describe your flow

Application

Global

Protection

-- None --

Run As

System User

Cancel

Submit

9. Click on Add a trigger

10. Select the trigger in that Search for “Service Catalog” and select that.

11. After that click on Done.

Flow VPN

Flow Email sending for P1

Flow Standard laptop task

+

Standard laptop task

Inactive

View:

TRIGGER

Abort trigger creation

Trigger

Select a Trigger

Search triggers

RECORD

Created

Updated

Created or Updated

DATE

Daily

Created

Trigger initiates from a ServiceNow record creation that meets the condition filter.

ACTIONS

+

Add an Action, Flow

ERROR HANDLER

TRIGGER

 Service Catalog  

Trigger Service Catalog ▼

Advanced Options ▼

Delete Cancel Done

12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for " Create Catalog Task " and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as " Laptop need to Configured ".
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as " Laptop need to Configured ".
22. Select Assignment group field and value as " Hardware ".
23. Select Approval field and value as " Approved ".
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



Standard Laptop task

Active

✕ Action Flow Logic Subflow

Search Actions

Create Catalog Task

Most Recent

Popular

INSTALLED SPOKES

- ServiceNow Core
- Connect
- AES Portal UI Template
- Deployment Pipeline
- Virtual Agent
- Password Reset
- AES Flow Templates
- Global

Create Catalog Task
ServiceNow Core

Look Up Record
ServiceNow Core

Wait For Condition
ServiceNow Core

Create Record
ServiceNow Core

SLA Percentage Timer
ServiceNow Core

Send Email
ServiceNow Core

Update Record
ServiceNow Core

Create Template ACL



Standard Laptop task

Active

View: [Icon] [Icon]

Test

De

1 Create Catalog Task ⓘ

Action: Create Catalog Task

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger - ... ▶ Requested Item ...

Short Description: Laptop needs to Configured

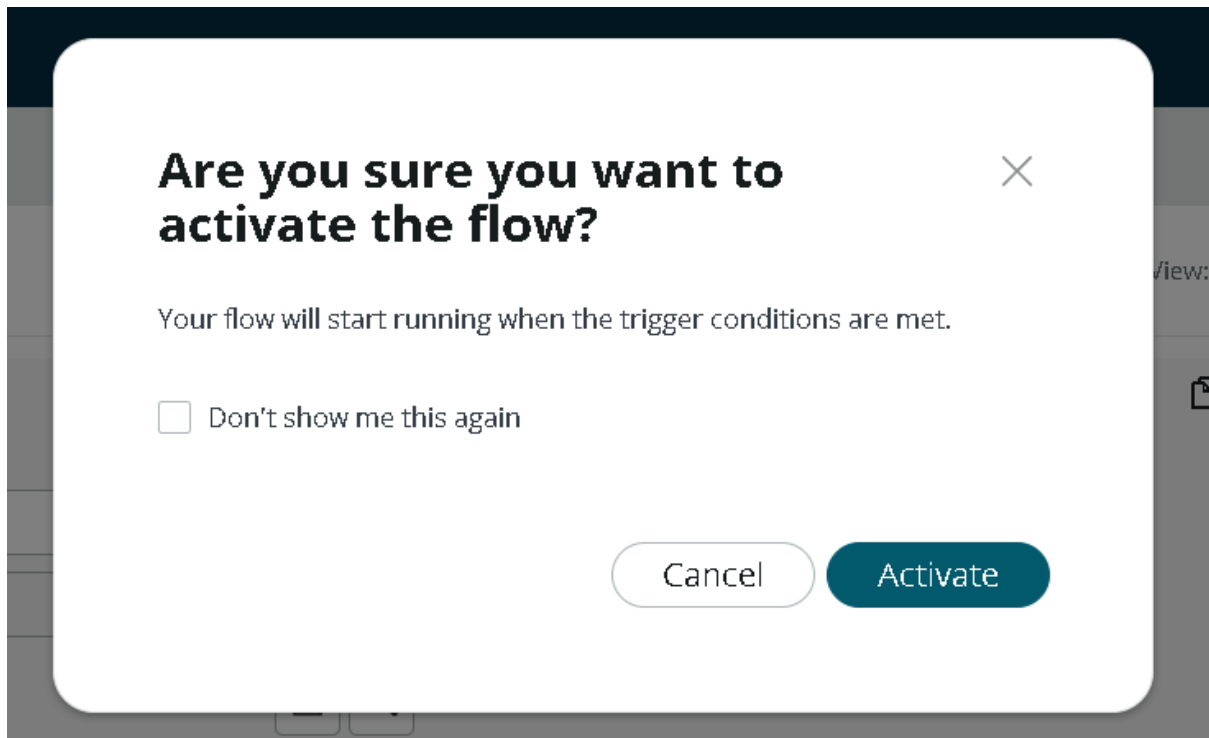
Fields:

Description	X	Laptop needs to Configured	[Icon]	[Icon]	⊖	
Assignment group	X	Hardware	X	[Icon]	[Icon]	⊖
Approval	X	Approved	[Icon]	[Icon]	⊖	

+ Add field value

Wait: ☒

Template Catalog: Select Template Catalog Item



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1: Assign the created Flow to the Standard Laptop service catalog item.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name " Standard Laptop Task".
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Place a Standard Laptop order through the Service Catalog and verify the approval.

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.

FavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Standard Laptop

Search

🌐🔍🔔👤

< Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop

🔍 Search catalog

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

- ☐ Adobe Acrobat
- ☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price

₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity

1

Subtotal

₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery

0 Days

Order Now

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

- Now we will see the Order status
- In that click on the Request Number

Order Status

Back to CatalogContinue ShoppingHome

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number: REQ0010001

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2024-04-17		₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually	1	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually
				Total	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Back to CatalogContinue Shopping

Home

- It will open the Requested number record.
- Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

FavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Request - REQ0010001

Search

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< Request REQ0010001

🔍🔍🔍⋮

DiscussFollowUpdateAdd New ItemCancel RequestCopyDelete

Short description

Special instructions

UpdateAdd New ItemCancel RequestCopyDelete

Related Links

Show WorkflowWorkflow Context

Requested Items (1) Approvers (1) Recurring Prices (1)

🔍 State Search

🔍 — Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links
[Show Workflow](#)
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1)

State

Approval for = REQ001

Approver Comments Created

2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Favorites History Workspaces Admin

Requested Item - RITM0010001

Search

Requested Item RITM0010001

Discuss Follow Update Delete

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

Impact 3 - Low

Opened by System Administrator

Priority 4 - Low

State Open

Update Delete

Related Links
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers Group approvals

Number Search

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the "Catalog tasks" Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

Catalog Task
SCTASK0010001

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Discuss

Follow

Update

Close Task

Delete

↑

↓

Number

SCTASK0010001

Approved

▼

Assigned to

🔍

Priority

4 - Low

▼

Configuration item

🔍

State

Open

▼

Active

✔️

Request item

RITM0010001

🔍

ℹ️

Short description

Laptop needs to Configured

Requested for

System Administrator

🔍

ℹ️

Description

Laptop needs to Configured

💡

📄

Work notes

Work notes

📄

Post

Activities: 1

🔍

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer, the project reduces repetitive manual activities and improves task handling. Once the request is approved, the workflow supports timely creation and assignment of the configuration task to the Hardware team. This helps reduce user waiting time, improves resource allocation, and provides a more consistent and efficient procurement experience.

